

Photorealism and Hyperrealism

Evolving from Pop art and opposed to both Minimalism and Abstract Expressionism, Photorealism revived the highly finished surfaces of 17th-century Dutch painting. From the late 1960s, skilful artists including Robert Bechtle (b.1932), Charles Bell (1935–95), Chuck Close (b.1940), Robert Cottingham (b.1935), Richard Estes (b.1932) and Audrey Flack (b.1931) mimicked photographic images, usually on a large scale, including areas of blurred focus and frozen motion. Hyperrealism developed about 20 years later, and as the name suggests, goes beyond the simulation of photography. Meticulously detailed, Hyperrealist paintings and sculptures create illusions of reality. Textures, surfaces, lighting effects and shadows appear clearer and more distinct than the reference photographs, as artists emphasize details. Unlike the literal detachment of Photorealism, Hyperrealism often incorporates emotional, social, cultural and political elements. High-profile Hyperrealists include Duane Hanson (1925–96), Ron Mueck (b.1958), Charles Bell and Denis Peterson (b.1944).



Domenico Gnoli, *Shoe*, 1969